



Pilgrim Paths

St Mary's, Kinnerton, LD8 2PE



5 miles circular walk

*Steep hills, rutted tracks and some obstacles
Kington Pilgrim Paths from St Mary's Church*

Welcome to the Kington Benefice Pilgrim Paths Project

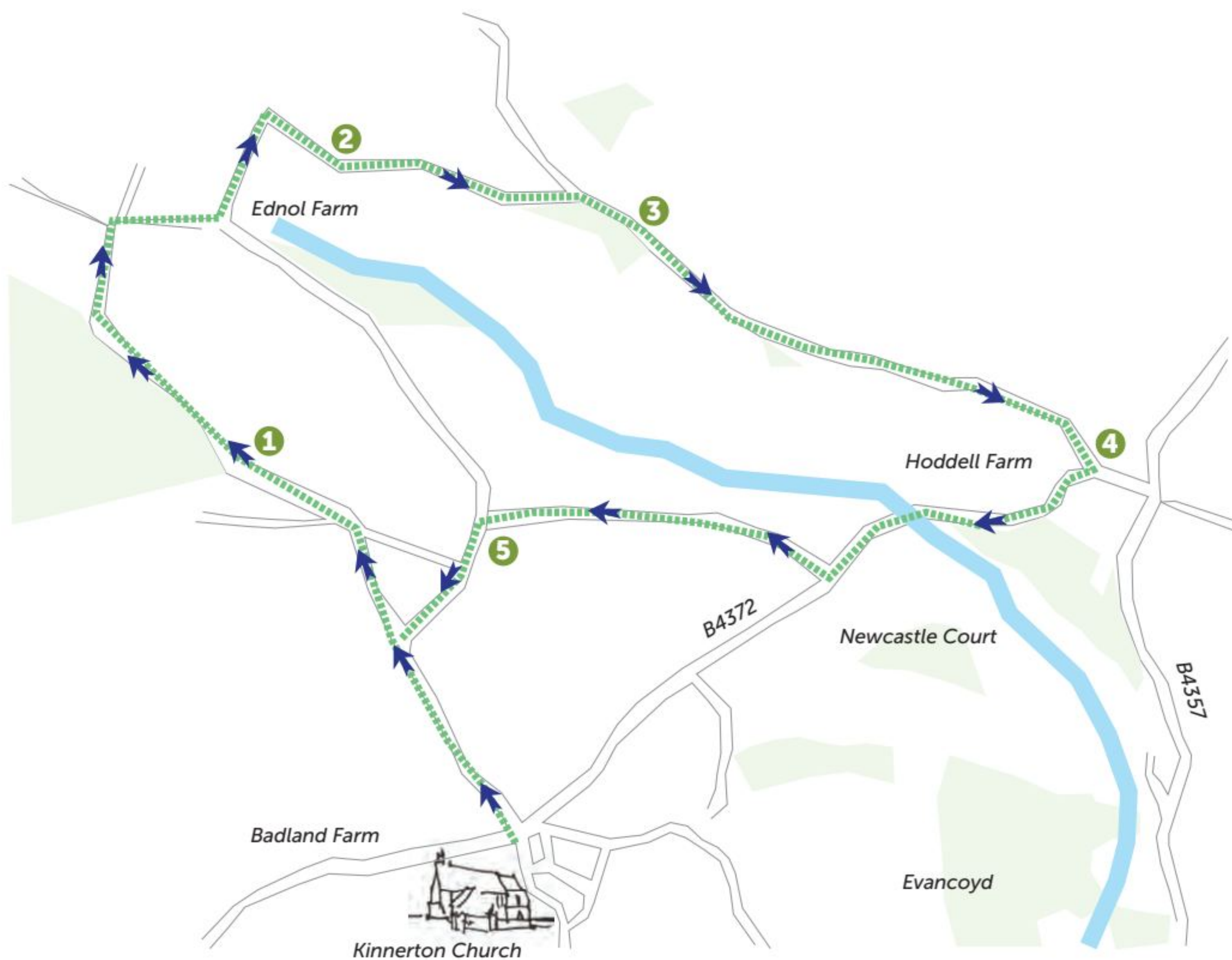
A pilgrimage is a spiritual journey to a sacred place. From earliest times, people have travelled to the 'thin places' of the world which offer opportunities for reflection and encounter. Pilgrim routes have shaped the landscape and history of this country from medieval times to the present day, as well as playing a major part in the spiritual journeys of many of its inhabitants.

The churches of the Kington Benefice offer you the hospitality of their buildings, which are open daily, and the opportunity to explore the local environment along ancient ways, through outstanding landscapes.

We invite you to make this short pilgrim journey in a spirit of openness to what it might offer, delight in the countryside through which you travel and companionship with those who have travelled this way before and will do so after you.

The reflections in this leaflet are based on the Psalms, 150 ancient poems which form part of the Christian Bible. They deal with the whole range of human experience and contain much wisdom. We hope you find them a useful source of encouragement and support as you journey.

*Kington Pilgrim Paths from St Mary's Church. 5 miles circular walk.
Steep hills, rutted tracks and some obstacles*



Look out for the Pilgrim Path
way markers around the walk



This walk has steep hills, rutted tracks and some obstacles. It is not suitable for buggies. It leads through fields with livestock - dogs must be kept on a lead at all times.

At the church door

Take a moment to be silent and still. Be aware of this place, yourself and the thoughts that come to mind. As a sign of readiness to receive all that the journey may offer, open your hands and accept this opportunity to look afresh at yourself and at the world that surrounds you. Psalm 121 is believed to have been used by pilgrims on their way to Jerusalem. Although you will not be facing the same physical dangers that they did, you can consider the things you fear in your own life.

I lift up my eyes to the hills - from where will my help come? ^(v1)

The psalmist answers their own question: My help comes from the Lord, who made heaven and earth. ^(v2)

Where do you look when you are frightened or facing danger?

Walk out of the church and go straight across the road, passing the village hall on your right.

At the sharp bend to your right take the footpath to the left of the white cottage and continue steeply up the hill.

At the top of the track go through the gate and keep to the field edge till you get to the end of

the field and through another gate.

Through the gate out of the field turn left on the track and keep straight on, ignoring the track to the left.

1 At the top of the hill, by the sign to Radnor Forest. Who is God?

The Lord is your keeper.^(v3)

It is part of God's identity to watch over, care for, protect and love. Think of all those whom you love, give thanks for all that they bring into your life and ask God's blessing on them. Pray for all who have responsibility for the wellbeing of others.

At the junction by the sign, take the right hand track. Where 2 tracks come in from the left take the footpath on the right and follow down the field edge to join the road at the bottom.

Turn right out of the field and continue on the tarmacked road. Down the hill past Ednol Cottage and as the road bends to the right take the steep rutted footpath on the left up the hill. Do not go through the gate at the top of the hill, take the right angled footpath and carry on the right hand side of the hedge at the left of the field

2 At the top of the next hill, looking back over the valley

*He who watches over Israel
Will neither slumber nor sleep.*^(v4)

As you look out over the valley, wonder at the beauty of the landscape and pray for all who live and work within it. Thank God for His tender, ever watchful care for all creation.

Stop by the tree mid way along the hedgerow. You can look back and see the ruins of the old chapel and your route on the opposite hill . Go through 4 gates keeping the hedge on your left. Take the fifth gate into barnyard. Be aware of any animals who might be there. Go through the gate straight ahead of you, to the left of a group of trees. Follow this track to its end, then through the gate and turn right along another track

3 At the junction with Ackwood Lane

*The Lord watches over you
The Lord is your shade at your
right hand.^(v5)*

Often, just when we think life will get easier, new challenges arise. Just as we can seek shelter in the love of God, so we might offer support and hope to others in our turn.

How might God be calling you to serve your community?

Follow the track all the way to its end, emerging onto the B4372 and turning right down hill

4 If you are walking with others, you might want to walk in silence here.

Walk down the hill, past a farm track to your right then uphill again

As the road climbs up again, two houses on your right. The footpath sign is just past the second house, leading through a gate into a field.

Follow the direction of the footpath sign, keeping your eyes fixed on the spot directly ahead of you where a hedge line ends. Once you meet this hedge line, follow it straight on, keeping the hedge to your left, into another field. The bridleway goes through the middle of the field here - it is clearly marked

Half way along, the path picks up the hedge line again. Follow this through two fields until you emerge through a gate onto the road up which you first walked.

5 *The Lord will keep you from all harm
He will watch over your life. ^(v7)*

These promises do not suggest that nothing bad will happen to those who walk in the shelter of God; only that they will never walk alone.

Look back on your life's journey and reflect on the times you have been aware of God's presence. Ask God for courage to face challenges to come.

Turn left and walk down the hill to the church.

Pilgrim God

*You are our origin and destination.
Travel with us, we pray, in every
pilgrimage of faith,
And every journey of the heart.
Give us the courage to set off,
The nourishment we need to travel well
And the welcome we long for
at journey's end.
So may we grow in grace and love of you
And in the service of others
Through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen*

(from Common Worship)



At the Church Door Again

You have reached the end of your pilgrimage and returned to your starting place. How has this journey been? What have you learned about God?

If you have walked with others, thank them for their company; if you have walked alone, pray for all who have made this journey before you.

Bless yourself and those with whom you have journeyed:

'May the Lord watch over your going out and your coming in from this time on and for evermore'.^(v8)



Pilgrim Paths

Kington Benefice

Pilgrim Paths across the Benefice

The circular walks include walking on local roads, bridleways and footpaths through woods and field. There are some stiles and some moderate ascents. You may encounter sheep, cattle or horses.

Countryside code : Respect, Protect, Enjoy!

Respect other people

- *Consider the local community and other people enjoying the outdoors*
- *Leave gates and property as you find them and follow paths unless wider access is available*

Protect the natural environment

- *Leave no trace of your visit and take your litter home*
- *Keep dogs under effective control*

Enjoy the outdoors

- *Plan ahead and be prepared*
- *Follow advice and local signs.*



Kington Benefice

www.kingtonparishes.org.uk